Smart Refugee Community Innovation Hub

A community-based initiative helping refugee and host-community youth build digital skills, explore innovation, and access practical opportunities.

Pitch deck first draft

Founder: Joseph Tawa Samuel

Location: Kakuma, Kenya

The Problem

Many young people in refugee and host communities face barriers to developing practical digital and entrepreneurship skills.

- Limited access to computers and reliable digital learning spaces
- Few opportunities to practise skills through real projects
- Challenges connecting learning to jobs, clients, and entrepreneurship
- Local needs and access differ; these points require validation with youth and partners

Our Solution

A shared learning and innovation hub offering practical training, guided projects, and links to opportunity.

- Digital literacy and computer applications
- Introductory web development, databases, and Python
- Project-based learning, peer support, and mentoring
- Entrepreneurship and digital work-readiness sessions

Target Users & Beneficiaries

The hub is designed for young people who want practical skills and a supportive place to learn.

- Primary users: youth in Kakuma refugee and host communities
- Potential groups: school leavers, students, job seekers, and aspiring entrepreneurs
- Potential partners: schools, community organizations, NGOs, and training providers
- Pilot assumption: start with one small cohort and adapt based on feedback

Market Opportunity

The initial opportunity is to test demand for accessible digital-skills training in the local community before expanding.

- Start with a needs survey and conversations with youth and organizations
- Map existing computer training, connectivity, and learning services
- Estimate demand using verified local population and partner data
- No market-size figure is claimed until reliable local data is collected

Services & Value Proposition

Affordable, practical, community-rooted learning that helps participants move from basic digital use toward applied projects.

- Short courses and guided practice sessions
- Portfolio projects such as simple websites and data tasks
- Career readiness: CVs, online applications, and professional communication
- A welcoming learning environment with peer collaboration

Business / Sustainability Model

Use a blended model so that participant affordability and long-term operating costs can be considered together.

- Free or subsidized places supported by grants and sponsors
- Affordable course fees where feasible and appropriate
- Paid digital services or workshops for organizations, if demand is validated
- In-kind support such as equipment, venue, connectivity, and volunteer mentoring

Outreach & Growth Strategy

Build trust locally, recruit a small pilot cohort, and grow through demonstrated results.

- Community meetings and referrals through schools and youth groups
- Demonstration days showing learner projects
- WhatsApp and social media updates with consent
- Partnership outreach to NGOs, training providers, and local organizations

Implementation Roadmap

A phased pilot will help test the model before making larger commitments.

- Month 1: consult youth and partners; confirm needs and safeguarding measures
- Month 2: secure venue, devices, connectivity, mentors, and learning materials
- Months 3–4: run a small pilot and collect attendance and feedback
- Month 5: review outcomes, improve the curriculum, and plan the next cohort

Illustrative Budget & Financial Plan

The budget will be finalized after local quotations, partner commitments, and pilot size are confirmed.

- Main cost areas: computers and maintenance, internet, venue, power, learning materials, and trainer time
- Possible resources: grants, sponsorships, course fees, and in-kind contributions
- Track monthly costs, learner attendance, course completion, and funds available
- Do not treat figures as confirmed until quotes and funding sources are documented

Team & Partnerships

The first phase will rely on clear roles and partnerships that complement local experience.

- Founder / project lead: Joseph Tawa Samuel — education and ICT training experience
- Proposed roles: trainer, community liaison, finance/admin support, and volunteer mentors
- Potential partners: community organizations, schools, NGOs, and technology professionals
- Additional team members and commitments to be confirmed before launch

Impact, Ask & Next Steps

We are seeking partners to help validate the need and support a practical, measurable pilot.

- Initial measures: enrolment, attendance, completion, projects completed, and participant feedback
- Longer-term measures: continued learning, work-readiness, internships, or income opportunities where trackable
- The ask: introductions, equipment, connectivity, mentoring, venue support, and pilot funding
- Next step: conduct a local needs assessment and prepare a costed pilot plan

Draft assumptions must be validated locally.